

Content overview

This unit requires students to study the nature of Islam and its effects on the lives of Muslim believers in the UK. There are four sections covering beliefs and values, community and tradition, worship and celebration, and living the Muslim life.

Key words are given at the beginning of each section. Students should be aware of their meanings and be able to use them in their examination answers. A glossary of the key words can be found in *Appendix 4*.

In order to meet Assessment Objective 2, students need to be aware of a range of responses addressing religious and/or non-religious beliefs.

Assessment overview

Assessment will be through a one-and-a-half-hour examination. The examination will be divided into four sections and students will be expected to choose one of the two questions set on each section, ie four questions in total. Each question is sub-divided into four parts structured on an incline of difficulty.

Religious Studies papers are designed to give access to the full range of grades and are not tiered.

Quality of Written Communication will be assessed through Assessment Objective 1 in part c) of each question.

Detailed unit content

Section 11.1 Beliefs and values

Students will be required to: demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the specification; express their own responses to the issues and questions raised by the specification using reasons and evidence; evaluate alternative points of view about these issues and questions.

Key words — al-Qadar, creativity, din, ibadah, iman, Islam, khalifah, Muslim, Qur'an, risalah, shirk, tawhid

- The nature and importance of belief in tawhid.
- The sin of shirk and why it is a major sin in Islam.
- The meaning and importance of belief in the creativity of Allah.
- The meaning and importance of belief in the mercy and compassion of Allah.
- The meaning and importance of belief in Islamic teaching on the nature of humans as khalifah, as shown in the Qur'anic teachings about Adam.
- The meaning and importance of belief in Islamic teaching on al-Qadar and human freedom.
- The meaning and importance of belief in Islamic teaching on angels.
- The meaning and importance of belief in risalah (how Allah communicates with humans).
- The meaning and importance of belief in Islamic teaching on holy books other than the Qur'an (tawrat, zabur, injil).
- The meaning and importance of belief in Islamic teaching on the revelation of the Qur'an to Muhammad.
- How belief in akhirah affects the lives of Muslims.